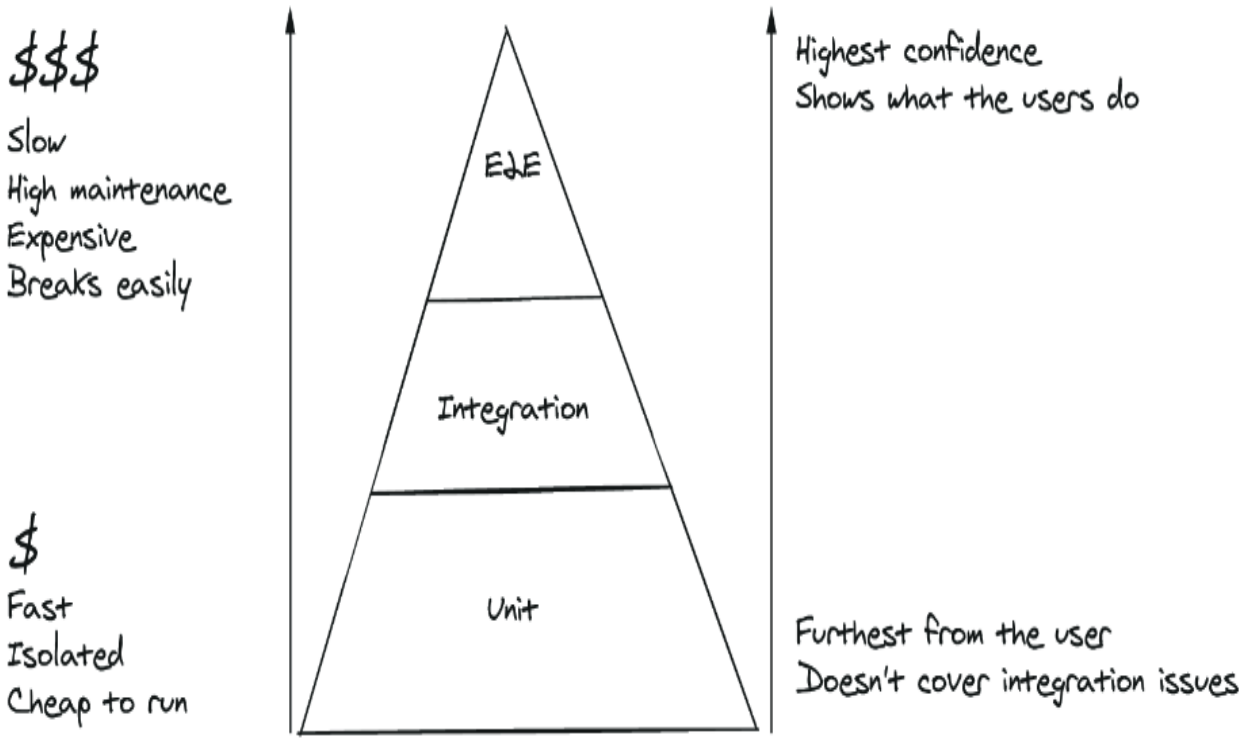


Figure 2.4 The original test automation pyramid comprising three horizontal sections: unit tests, integration tests, and E2E tests

In the original test automation pyramid, there are three primary layers: unit tests at the base level, followed by integrations tests in the middle, and E2E tests at the top level. The test automation pyramid suggests that most automated tests should be predominantly unit tests, complemented by a smaller number of integration tests, and a further reduced number of E2E tests because the higher you go up the pyramid, the slower and more expensive the tests are, even though the higher-level tests are the closest to verifying the user's experience.

The test automation pyramid also provides a visual representation of the ideal test automation distribution and highlights the need for a balanced approach. With the balanced approach, teams can use the speed and isolation of unit tests, the integration validation of integration tests, and the full user coverage of E2E tests. Let's take a look at these different types of testing briefly.